T-34 TANKMAN'S KIT

The Red Army tankmen fighting the Nazi invaders in what Russians call "the Great Patriotic War" were kitted out in solidly utilitarian fashion. They were consistently better supplied with clothing for fighting in freezing weather conditions than were their enemies. From 1943 insignia of rank, which had been abolished in the egalitarian spirit of the Russian Revolution of 1917, were reinstated, taking the traditional Russian form of *pogoni* (shoulder-boards).

> "NEVER HAVE I RECEIVED SUCH AN OVERWHELMING IMPRESSION OF RUSSIAN STRENGTH AND NUMBERS AS ON THAT DAY."
>
> **GERMAN SOLDIER**, DESCRIBING THE BATTLEFIELD AT PROKHOROVKA ON 12 JULY 1943

Schuba
This winter sheepskin overcoat, or *schuba*, was issued to Soviet armoured crews. It is without insignia, but could be fitted with shoulder boards. Worn instead of the *telogreika*, it is still used by crewmen today.

Tanker's helmet
For reasons of economy, this 1941-model helmet was made of canvas. Its predecessor, of 1939, was made of leather.







Goggles
Made of non-shatterproof glass, Red Army goggles were of a universal model shared by tankers, aircrew, and motorcyclists.


Goggles worn over helmet


Strap for provisions bag